

Day 7 — Sky Watchers (Indian Astronomy)

Module: Five Gifts (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Children hear the Aryabhata story and try the “spinning earth” demo.

Materials

- A ball (any size) with a small mark on it
- Open space

Flow

Settle + chant + song (5 min)

Story (10 min)

“About 1500 years ago, a young man in India named Aryabhata had a BIG idea.”

“In his time, everyone thought the stars went round and round the earth — that’s why the sun rises and sets, why stars move.”

“Aryabhata thought: ‘What if the stars stand still — and WE spin?’”

“He was right! He was 1000 years before anyone in Europe figured this out.”

“He wrote a book called the Aryabhaṭīya. He was only 23 years old.”

Demo (10 min)

- Hold the ball. Put a sticker or mark on it.
- Slowly spin the ball.
- *“If you were standing on this little mark, what would you see? You’d see the room going round and round. But it’s not. YOU are spinning.”*
- Stand the children up. Slowly spin in place 3 times. *“Look around. Did the room move, or did you?”*

Drawing (3 min)

Quick: draw the earth as a ball, with you standing on it.

Show + chant (2 min)

Homework

- Tonight, look up at the stars. Notice that the stars seem to move. They don't. WE'RE moving.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Why don't we feel the earth spinning? (Because we're moving WITH it.)
- **Tier down:** Just remember: Aryabhata said WE spin, not the sky.